

Towards Reproducible Relationship Formation for Overworked Male Researchers

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Abstract—In this paper, we investigate whether emotionally sincere, career-oriented male researchers can achieve stable romantic outcomes without adopting a generic “dating app persona”. Through iterative field deployment on Bumble, we evaluate the impact of authenticity-preserving interaction strategies, early coffee escalation, and self-deprecating humor on reciprocal engagement metrics.

Index Terms—online dating, relationships, work-life balance

I. RESEARCH QUESTION

Can a person remain ambitious, weird, sincere, and still be loved?

II. HYPOTHESIS

Authenticity + warmth + competence + timely escalation outperform emotionally detached optimization strategies for niche-compatible matches.

III. EVALUATION

A. Experimental Setup

- Baseline Chris
 - Lengthy app conversations
 - Ambiguity anxiety
- Chance-Informed Chris
 - Earlier escalation
 - Coffee-first methodology

B. Key Metrics

- Time-to-asking-out (TTAO)
- Relative Approachability Index (RAI)
 - Response enthusiasm
 - Reciprocity
 - Emoji density

C. Preliminary Results

See Figure 1.

IV. DISCUSSION

Excessive texting without real-world escalation exhibits high conversational entropy. Warmth and specificity can outperform generic dating app optimization behaviors in niche-compatible populations.

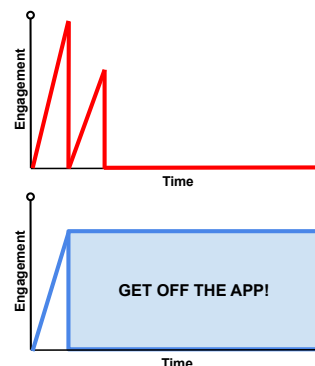


Fig. 1. A/B Test of Chris Baseline vs. Chance-Informed Chris

A. Limitations

We outline key limitations that may affect absolute performance but do not alter the observed trends. Our study is evaluated on a small sample size (3 meaningful matches). We did not control for confounding hidden-state variables such as work-life bandwidth collapse, app disengagement, or stochastic romantic failure from matches.

V. CONCLUSION

Yes :^)

A. Future Work

- Longitudinal relationship resilience studies
- Pet-assisted emotional regulation experiments